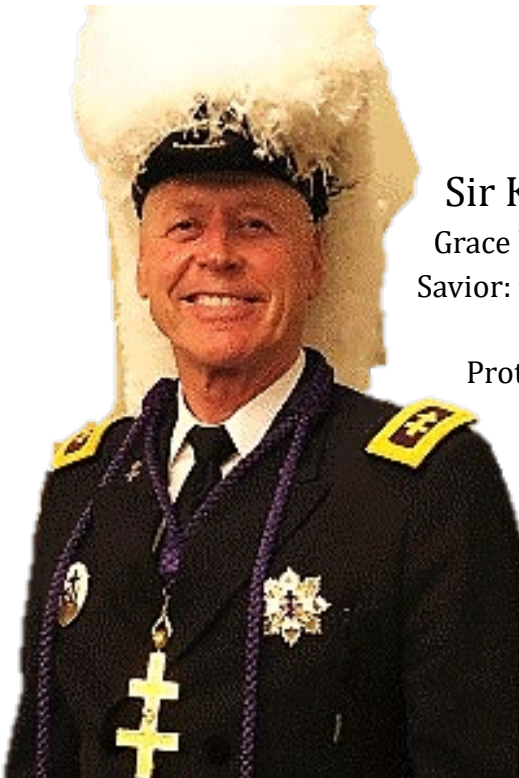


Grand Encampment of Knights Templar of the United States of America



Address to the 114th Annual Conclave of the Grand Commandery of Knights Templar of the State of Utah

Saturday, 11 May, 2024



Sir Knights,

Grace be with you; mercy and peace from our Lord and
Savior: the Great Captain of our Salvation!

Protocol having been established ... I bring you greetings
from Sir Knight David J. Kussman, KGCT, KTCH, KCT -
Most Eminent Grand Master of the Grand
Encampment Knights Templar of the United States of
America.

To attract attractive people, you have to *be* attractive.
To put it another way: you attract who you *are* and
what you are. John C. Maxwell* says you can't have a

leadership quotient of 6 and expect to attract 7, 8, and 9s. At best, you'll attract a 5. We attract who we are, not what we want.

Sometimes when we want a new member, or retain one, or restore one for that matter ... we go to work on them, when the *REAL* key is to go to work on yourself and your Commandery. And become attractive ...

SO. What do we have that makes us attractive?

- Order of the Temple. (Done well.)
- Holy Land Pilgrimage.
- Knight Templar Magazine
- Eye Foundation.
- Leadership classes
- Christian Order with Easter, Christmas, and Ascension observances
- Honor guard
- Uniform. It may not be a selling point for some, but I LOVE it.
- Programs about Christian history and Ancient Templar history

Maybe you don't have an honor guard and you don't know how to go about putting one together. My dream is to have a complete instructional video on our website that shows you EXACTLY how to do it.

I believe a sharp honor guard is not only fantastic for the very positive exposure of Templary, but also makes the Sir Knights proud to be a part of it. Really, being part of a group that looks sharp and impressive doing what they do is very exciting! I remember when I joined the Shrine bagpipe band....

And all of this takes good leadership to lead Sir Knights to want to make it happen.

The problem is we treat leadership with intensity. We have a one or two-day seminar ... we invite a bunch of speakers ... we give everybody a certificate --- you're a leader! Those things are like going to the dentist --- very important and good for reminding us, of getting us back on track ... Learning new lessons but it's the daily practice of all the monotonous little boring things that matter the most.

Leadership is exactly the same. There's no event, there's no single thing I can tell you that you have to do - that will make your people trust you ... it just doesn't work that way. But if you do it consistently and you do it in combination with lots of other little things like saying good morning to *everyone* you encounter ...

Let me emphasize how important this is for the Masonic fraternity. We don't have a membership problem. We have a leadership problem.

Back in the day, we had good leadership because almost all of the community leaders belonged to the Lodge. Maybe they joined because it was the popular thing to do, but we benefited from their leadership.

Today, fewer and fewer of the leaders in the community are joining us, and even those that do are rarely involved other than paying their dues.

The upshot is that Masonic organizations end up with folks in positions of leadership who have no idea about what leadership even looks like! What do I do now?

Poor leadership sometimes comes about because of us. We promote our friends into positions of leadership when a better choice is ready and willing. So we pass over the best guy for the spot because we like our buddy "Ol' Joe". We simply **CANNOT** afford for your vote to be based on anything other than qualifications. Not friendship, but merit!

OR...even worse, we **DISLIKE** the best guy for the job because of some personal thing that has nothing to do with the job. So, you support and vote for the other guy because of the hatred in your heart for the best guy.

It's like we have a roster spot open for the Utah Jazz. Michael Jordan is available, but you choose to promote your friend Jeff Bolstad for the job because he's a good guy...he's from my town and he wants to play. And besides Jordan refused to give you his autograph when you, a Sir Knight, asked him very nicely ... so you can't stand Michael Jordan. Or you think he's playing for the wrong reasons. So Jeff might be an OKAY choice if Michael Jordan isn't in the mix, but putting Jeff Bolstad on the team instead of Michael Jordan isn't for the good of the order ... it's for the good of your buddy ... or your animosity for Mike.

Say you're going to have open heart surgery. Do you want the best surgeon or the guy who you like to have a beer with? Remember, the M+A+S+H+ movie ... *"the pros from Dover."* The General's son needed open heart surgery. The General hated Hawkeye and Trapper because of their irreverent attitude and lack of protocol. But he flew them in from their remote M+A+S+H+ unit to the U.S. Army hospital in Tokyo to operate on his kid. Why? ... Because they were the best. Like they told the nurse there at the hospital. "Relax. The pros from Dover are here." - Back to our Lodge situation.

Now we've created a situation where the best guy for the spot gets discouraged, and we never see him again. Meanwhile, "Ol' Joe" just fills the spot because he wants the title ... and probably really wants the title of *Past Whatever* and nothing happens, and the Commandery continues to swirl the drain. Or even worse, the power associated with the position goes to his head, and he drives everyone away with abuse of his position and high-handed edicts.

And then he appoints one of *his* buddies to the bottom of the line, without any regard to leadership ... because he doesn't care about it. He only cares that it's his buddy.

I have never considered myself an *expert* on leadership, but I am a die-hard student!

So, what do we do?

First thing is to vote for the good of the order, not for the good of our buddy. You hear a term tossed about a lot these days ... and I mentioned it earlier ... **SERVANT Leadership**. So, let's talk about that a little bit. I've got nothing new for you today. Everything you need to know you already know. Because really - all it is, is just doing the right thing. Treat people the way you want to be treated. Be the boss you wish your boss would be.

We clearly know the difference between servant leaders and self-serving leaders. And what's happening now is that people are choosing servant leadership because they recognize it's the right thing to do. To serve other people.

So that's what I do. I teach people about stuff that they learned a long time ago. I don't instruct, I remind people. Everything I talk about I stole all this stuff —it's been around forever.

It's the right thing to do to have patience and self-control with people. It's the right thing to do to be kind. It's the right thing to do to listen. It's the right thing to be humble. The right thing to be respectful.

That's all leadership is - it's just doing the right thing.

You're not a leader unless there are those who volunteer to follow you. You cannot force someone to follow you. They have to choose to follow you.

Leaders inspire people to follow them, they inspire people to go in the direction they are going. AND ... In order to inspire those people in your charge...you have to know your why.

Every single person and organization knows WHAT they do 100%. Some know how they do it ... But very few people know WHY they do what they do.

And By “why” - I mean ... what’s your purpose?

- What’s your cause?
- What’s your belief? Why does your organization exist?
- WHY do you want to be Grand Master?
- WHY do you want to be Grand Commander?
- WHY do you want to be Potentate?

People don’t buy into what you do, they buy into why you do it.

But if you don’t know why you do what you do.... And people respond to why you do what you do, then how will you ever get someone to vote for you, buy something from you, or more importantly be loyal and want to be a part of what it is that you do.

People don’t buy what you do, they buy why you do it. And if you talk about what you believe, you will attract those who believe what you believe.

It has nothing to do with how smart you are or talented you are or being the superstar of your team.

David Wade Ross, until last year, was the manager of the Chicago Cubs. Back when he was a player, he bounced around quite a bit. He got cut from the Cincinnati Reds because he was a bad teammate ...because he wasn’t someone who made other people better.

And in that experience, one of the things that he came to realize, was that if he could learn how to make other people better ... If he could be a great teammate .., he might have a greater future in the game of baseball. He committed himself to that very thing. He went to the Atlanta Braves and He started polling everybody who came through the locker room.

He asked them to tell him — what is it about the greatest teammate you ever had ... he said “give me three words to describe that teammate,” and he built himself a list of what it meant to become a great teammate; and every day before he took the field he checked the

boxes to say ... “I’m going to be a teammate that will make others better, whether I play or not.”

And what he learned was that you can be invaluable without ever being *MOST* valuable. You can become invaluable in your organization without ever being the best in your team.

David would teach us that we can become special in any organization that we choose to join if we elect to make other people better.

He built a list, made that his checklist every day, and over the course of the next several years - he not only became a great teammate, he became one of the most valuable players in baseball. Other teams wanted him because ... he wasn’t a great player but he made the locker room better. He made the environment better, and as a result, he got to be in two World Series and win two championship rings.

When the seventh game of the World Series was played in Cleveland and the Cubs won it, the game ended and the guy that the players carried off the field on their shoulders was a backup catcher named David Wade Ross - because he made other people better. — That is leading without being in a leadership position.

Some of you might know the story of Sven Nader. He was a first-round draft pick out of college.... he had a successful pro basketball career, and is the only player to lead both, the NBA and the old ABA in rebounds. But he never started a game in college. He played at UCLA and when John Wooden went to recruit him He said I want you to come to UCLA and you’ll probably never play.

But Sven knew he had a role, and his role was to make other people better on the team, and he realized that the difference he made, would make a greater difference ... than if he went to some other school where he could play all the time. Sven was on two National Championship teams; and Bill Walton says, to this day, that the toughest center he played against was in practice every day at UCLA.

There’s a lot of talk about Michael Jordan ... talk about Kobe Bryant ... about Larry Bird; but, there are a lot more Sven Naders in the world that need to be able to fulfill their role in making others better ... because there are only a few superstars ... but we can all be the one that uplifts the team. We can all lead by serving and inspiring our teammates.

The **BEST** leaders understand that they’re only as good as the people around them.

So, if you want to learn leadership, here's my advice ... become a student. Spend some time every day reading about it, watching videos ... listening to podcasts. Or, flat-out practicing leadership. Touch base with your people. I call every single one of the guys on my team – every single day. There are many leadership gurus out there and you can't be exposed too much to any of it.

If you haven't taken the York Rite Leadership Program** training course, I encourage you to do so. I have been to lots of seminars and workshops over the years. I would not hesitate to put our product up against any of them. And if you have already taken all our leadership courses, I challenge you to take them again. Why not? It's free. You can go online and take at least two of our courses.

When I look in the mirror I don't see a leader... I see a servant. And I pray every morning that the Holy Spirit will fill my heart with the grace to serve you ... particularly in your leadership journey.

There are leaders and then there are those who lead. Leaders hold a position of power or authority ... But those who lead - inspire us ... and we follow those who lead, not because we have to; but because we want to.

Always be working on your leadership quotient. Evaluate yourself honestly. The higher your level of leadership, the higher the quality of members you will attract to your team.

Remember ... it's not about you. It's about those you serve.

One last story.

There was a former undersecretary of defense who was invited to give a speech at a large conference of about 1000 people. And he was standing on the stage with his cup of coffee, in his styrofoam cup ... and he took a sip of his coffee and smiled. And he looked down at the coffee and he went off script.

And he said "You know last year I spoke at this exact same conference. Last year I was still the undersecretary. And when I spoke here last year, they flew me here business class. And when I arrived at the airport, there was somebody waiting for me to take me to my hotel, and they took me to my hotel; and they had already checked me in, and they just took me up to my room.

And the next morning, I came downstairs, and there was someone waiting in the lobby to greet me; and they drove me to this, here same venue ... and handed me a cup of coffee in a beautiful ceramic cup.

He says “Now I’m no longer the undersecretary. I flew here coach. I took a taxi to my hotel and I checked myself in. When I came down to the lobby this morning I took another taxi to this Venue. And when I asked someone “do you have any coffee?” He pointed to the coffee machine in the corner, and I poured myself a cup of coffee into this here Styrofoam cup.”

He says, “The lesson is ... the ceramic cup was never meant for me. It was meant for the position I held. I deserve a styrofoam cup. “

He goes on to state, “Remember this. As you gain fame ... as you gain fortune ... as you gain position, and seniority; people will treat you better. They will hold doors open for you, they will get you a cup of coffee without you even asking ... NONE of that stuff is meant for you. That stuff is meant for the position you hold. It is meant for the level that you have achieved ... leader or success or whatever you want to call it ...but you will always deserve a styrofoam cup. Remember that lesson of humility and Gratitude.”

You can accept all the free stuff — you can accept all the perks. Absolutely, you can enjoy them. But just be grateful for them and know that they’re not for you.

Servant leadership is for those who want to inspire others in service to our Lord and Savior.

OR, for those who want to be inspired. I can say without a doubt...YOU, inspire me.

Thank you for your support,
Thank you for your prayers.
Thank you for your inspiration.
Thank you for your friendship

God bless you all.
Yours in Knightly Courtesy,

Sir Knight Jeffrey Alan Bolstad, REPGC, 33° PR Montana (+)
Right Eminent Deputy Grand Master
of the Grand Encampment Knights Templar of the United States of America.

Note:

* Leadership expert John C. Maxwell, in his book 'The 21 Irrefutable Laws Of Leadership', outlines a simple yet profound concept: "who you are is who you attract." You might not have noticed this before, but chances are the people you hire all have something in common—they share similarities with you.

Leadership Law No. 9 - The Law of Magnetism

In his chapter on the Law of Magnetism, John Maxwell makes an essential but not always obvious point: Your employees likely have much in common with you. People tend to gravitate toward others who are similar. You might notice this in your friend groups, and it's true of employees.

**** The York Rite Leadership Program : Problem Solving Through Effective Leadership**

Hosted by the Grand Encampment Knights Templar of the United States of America. Co-Sponsored by the General Grand Chapter Royal Arch Masons International and the General Grand Council Cryptic Masons International.

This program is designed to enhance your leadership abilities. The elements of this training are self-improvement, understanding others, and powerful communication skills. In this training you will learn to create team bonding, empower individuals to be effective team leaders, and understand how to highlight the strengths and mitigate the weaknesses of every member. The outcome of this training is sure to improve the craft and you will notice improvements in your work and family life as well.

Frequently Asked Questions:

- **What is the York Rite Leadership Training Program?**

The York Rite Leadership organization is a Center of Excellence that delivers executive-class leadership training and coaching to all Masonic leaders wherever dispersed.

- **How do I earn the Leadership Award Coin?**

The Leadership Award Coin is a prestigious symbol of your commitment to learning and practicing masonic leadership principles.

The coin is given out for completion of the in-person classes. These classes are held at various events and are designated as the x02 classes.

When you attend the 102 you will receive the Personal Effectiveness coin segment. Attending the 202 class will earn you the Group Dynamics coin segment and attending the 402 class will earn you the Influential Communication coin segment.

Online class completion does not earn a coin segment. You must attend an in-person class.

- **Who should consider this program?**

Any member of the Masonic family may participate. We do ask that the youth be mature. For guidance, a young gentleman or lady who is between 14 and 18 and has a mature outlook may be admitted. Admission is always at the discretion of the instructor.

- **How is the program structured?**

The current York Rite Leadership Training Program consists of six well-developed courses, exploring the theory and practice within three bodies of knowledge (BOK) that are designed to give you the skills to be a better leader of yourself and others.

The three BOKs are:

100 – Personal Effectiveness

200 – Group Dynamics

400 – Influential Communication

The online courses (101, 201, and 401) are theory based courses.

The in-person courses (102, 202, and 402) engage the students in the class in exercises putting into practice the concepts presented.

The in-person classes are held at the Grand Encampment Department Conferences and other events by demand.

Graduation from the program means you have completed at least one class from each of the bodies of knowledge, either online or in-person. Keep in mind that there is always more to learn and you are welcome to repeat any of the classes when they are offered.

Will I receive a certification after completing this program?

A certificate of completion is provided for the completion of every course.

Remember: Attending the in-person courses also results in receiving one of the coin segments.

- **How much does the program cost?**

There is no cost for the class itself. If you are attending an in-person class at a conference or at a sponsored event, there may be a fee required. You will be responsible for registering for the event and paying their fee, paying for any meals you wish to have, and your hotel and travel expenses.

- **How do I apply for the program?**

The first step is to apply for admission. After you have been approved for admission, you will begin to receive notifications of classes as registration opens.

- **I am attending an online training (VILT), when will I get the link?**

The link to attend online training is sent the day before the training, after enrollments have closed.

<https://yorkriteleadership.org/>

(+) Sir Knight Jeffrey Alan Bolstad, REPGC, 33° PR Montana
Right Eminent Deputy Grand Master
of the Grand Encampment Knights Templar of the United States of America.

Lewistown, MT

SK Jeffrey Alan Bolstad has lived his entire life in various places in Montana. He was raised on a farm in extreme NE Montana, just a few miles from Saskatchewan and North Dakota. He studied at Montana State and Brown Institute of Broadcasting, which spawned a radio career that lasted 10 years. Eventually he was fortunate enough to be able to open up his own business as a State Farm insurance agent. SK Jeff began his Masonic journey on May 7, 1990 and has been heavily involved in the craft ever since. He was knighted at Bozeman in February 1998, then served as Grand Commander, and NWDC. He was elected GCG August 21, 2018 at Indianapolis. He has served in many leadership positions across the Masonic spectrum. He has filled the pulpit at several rural churches as an interim pastor over the years and also enjoyed refereeing high school and college basketball. He has 2 sons and 6 grandchildren.

Jeff Bolstad is a native of Homestead, Montana, born on Christmas day, 1956. He began his career in radio, doing the morning show and broadcasting hundreds of sporting events. In 1980 and 1981 he was honored by UPI as "Sportscaster of the Year."

In 1986, Jeff moved to Helena and began his career as a State Farm insurance agent.

Over the years, he has been heavily involved in community service, including the Helena Lions Club where he is a past president, and several years on the Chamber of commerce Sports Committee, and the Montana Governor's Cup Marathon Committee. He serves on the board of directors of the Montana Cowboy Hall of Fame and Western Heritage Center and a long time high school and college basketball referee.

For ten years he made a weekly 350-mile journey to serve as the pastor of the Valier Lutheran Church. He began his Masonic journey in 1990 when he was initiated into Helena Lodge No. 3, where he served as Worshipful Master. He also was the Master of King Solomon No. 9 in Helena.

Sir Knight Jeff became a member of the Helena York Rite Bodies in 1998, eventually becoming High Priest, Illustrious Master, and Commander. He joined Big Sky York Rite College No. 74 and was awarded the Purple Cross in 2002, served as Governor in 2008, and is a Past Grand Governor of Montana. He was Grand Commander in 2013-2014, and is a Past Grand High Priest.

He has served as the presiding officer in all four Scottish Rite Bodies, and in 2003 was appointed as Personal Representative of the SGIG in Montana. In 2005 he was coroneted with the 33rd Degree, Honorary Inspector General in Washington DC.

For seven years he was a member of the Board of Governors at Shriners Hospital in Spokane, and was elected twice to three year terms as a trustee of the Montana Masonic Home Board. For several years he was the Algeria Shriners membership chairman, PR chairman, and editor of the Algeria Shrine newsletter. He also spent five years as an officer on the Divan.

An ardent life-long student of the art of leadership, motivation, and personal development, Jeff has presented several workshops and seminars, mostly for Masonic organizations, and for the 2006-2009 triennial served as the director of the leadership development program for the General Grand Chapter, Order of Eastern Star. He is a Past Grand Patron of the Montana Grand Chapter.

He and his beautiful wife Jill, a pediatric medical doctor, like to spend as much time as they can at their ranch near Lewistown, where they enjoy catching trout, hunting pheasants and caring for critters. He is known as the “cowboy poet laureate” of the Charlie Russell Chew-choo, a popular dinner train in Central Montana. They have five grown children, five granddaughters, and one grandson.

SK Jeff was elected Grand Captain General at the 67th Triennial Conclave in Indianapolis, August 21, 2018.